

Question 1

What, in your opinion, is the single most critical success factor for a sustainable Agile transformation within a large organization?

Management behaviour that matches the operating model. Frameworks, coaches and tooling help, but transformation sticks only when leaders change how they prioritise, decide and react under pressure. If management still rewards local optimisation, silent risk and last-minute scope dumps, teams will perform agility as theatre.

In practice that means: one prioritised portfolio truth, decision rights that match team autonomy, metrics used for learning rather than blame, and coaches who can challenge upwards. Everything else (maturity assessments, roadmaps, TOM, KPIs) exists to make that leadership shift visible and durable.

Question 2

In a maximum of 2 pages, describe how you translate a transformation vision into a concrete roadmap, governance framework, leadership model, measurable objectives, and organizational buy-in. Illustrate with a real-world case study and your personal role.

How I translate vision into execution

I use a simple sequence and keep artefacts short enough that management will use them.

- **Assess, do not assume.** Map current ways of working, governance, leadership habits, and collaboration with architecture, security and portfolio. Name strengths, gaps and risks in plain language.
- **Target state and TOM.** Agree the future operating model: roles, decision rights, and how strategic / tactical layers connect to teams.
- **Roadmap with decisions.** Turn vision into short, medium and long-term initiatives with milestones, owners, dependencies and the decisions leadership must take.
- **Governance that fits IT.** Translate agile principles into workable meeting cadence, escalation paths and portfolio rules, not more ceremony.
- **Measurable objectives.** Define a small KPI / OKR set for flow, predictability, quality and maturity indicators, with a reporting rhythm management can read in minutes.
- **Buy-in through coaching both sides.** Coach the Agile Coaching Team for autonomy, and coach management on behaviours that protect the model when pressure rises. Knowledge transfer is part of every deliverable.

Case study: KBC Bank and Verzekering (Brussels / Leuven), 2021 to 2024

Context. Multi-country EMEA IT delivery across Belgium, Hungary, Czech Republic and Bulgaria, with onshore-offshore partners. Regulated workstreams (including liquidity reporting, Kate Coin under ECB constraints, and GDPR) competed for the same capacity. Management needed reliable delivery and a more mature Agile way of working, not another disconnected improvement list.

My role. Delivery Lead with day-to-day ownership of people coaching in the delivery vertical, capacity and priority arbitration, Agile maturity raising across squads and trains, and SteerCo / senior management communication. I worked with Product, Scrum Masters, architects, business and Risk.

Question 2 (continued)

Maturity and analysis. I assessed how squads and trains actually planned, escalated and reported. Strengths included committed people and strong domain expertise. Gaps included uneven backlog readiness, slow impediment closure across countries, and leadership packs that described activity more than outcomes. I challenged process that looked agile but did not improve predictability or decision speed.

Roadmap. Together with Product and management stakeholders I translated programme and transformation goals into a prioritised roadmap: stabilize capacity and sprint-goal ownership first, then raise coaching depth in the delivery vertical, then harden cross-train dependency management. Milestones were tied to SteerCo dates and regulatory windows so the roadmap stayed real.

Governance and operating rhythm. We clarified who owned intake, who could cut scope mid-sprint, and how country dependencies escalated within days. I kept alignment between team execution, portfolio pressure and management expectations so strategic goals did not arrive as surprise demand.

Leadership model. I coached and challenged leaders to treat delivery health as a management responsibility: protect focus, make trade-offs explicit, and stop rewarding local heroics that broke system flow. Workshops and 1:1s focused on behaviours (transparency, arbitration, follow-through on retro actions), not slogans.

Measurable objectives. Leadership packs tracked capacity vs demand, delivery risks, and progress against committed outcomes. We used flow and predictability signals so continuous improvement had evidence. Success looked like fewer late surprises, clearer ownership, and coaches / Scrum partners solving more without escalation.

Buy-in. Buy-in came from making problems visible with data, proposing concrete next actions, and transferring methods to the people who stay. I coached Scrum Masters and delivery partners so the vertical could sustain practices after each improvement wave.

Personal contribution. I personally ran the assessment conversations, wrote and defended the improvement priorities in leadership forums, facilitated the operating rhythm changes, coached the delivery vertical, and owned the narrative that connected vision to weekly execution. That is the same pattern I would apply to AWOW and EITS: assess, roadmap, TOM and governance, KPIs, coach the Coaching Team, and challenge management until behaviours match the model.